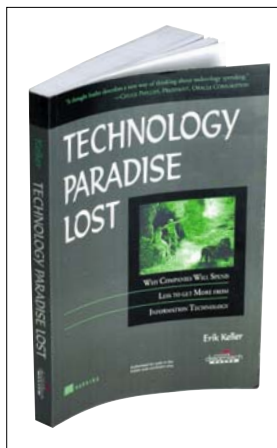


IT Will Not Fuel The Future

Technology Paradise Lost is hell-bent on proving that the computer industry has sputtered somewhere down the 1990s and is in no mood to regain its power. Eminent IT consultant and speaker Erik Keller cites several examples and offers hard facts to back his claim. And he does it well. Keller has done his homework—he was a technical journalist for 10 years and worked for research company Gartner as a technology analyst.

Keller reasons that it all had to do with irrational spending on software, and other such factors. Companies realised that they had better pull up their socks and ask for reasons for spending on IT.

The pace does slacken in between all the business and figures that Keller doles out. However, it does pick up as he takes you through conversations in boardroom meetings and luncheons that vividly portray how IT spending charted its course in American IT corporations.



Keller takes the example of companies such as Merrill Lynch which did cut IT spending and gained competitively. And he positions offshoring as one of the key factors that have fuelled the cut. He says that with its cheap-labour-more-skill tag, offshoring is here to stay.

Keller does not write off IT completely. His viewpoint is that it will remain the focus of competitiveness as companies spend less to get more out of IT. He doles out survival tips for companies that are downsizing IT departments and implementing cheap IT solutions.

Technology Paradise Lost is worth a read. Read it to know where and how

companies stumble and how they can avoid stumbling blocks as they chart their IT expenditure.

Garfield D'Souza

Technology Paradise Lost
Publisher **Dreamtech Press**
Author **Erik Keller**
Web Site www.wapitilc.com
Price **Rs 399**

Books

Spiderman 2

Activision's Spiderman 2 starts with a cut-scene—a direct lift from the movie. Then, no drama, no tension, nothing! Training levels are a piece of cake. You control Spidey with the standard mouse-keyboard combination. As for the controls, you can shoot webs, swing from poles, punch, zip around, entangle enemies in your web, and snatch their guns. Basically, the left-mouse button does it all.

There's not much you can do as far as combat goes. If you get bored, jump and kick, and then get back to punching. Variety-wise, Spidey can shoot webs to pull guns away from enemies, who don't even know what they are supposed to do.

All baddies can be taken care of by clicking the mouse button at warp speed.

The graphics are just about acceptable; not so with the sound. With



no freedom to speak of, inane gameplay, a pathetic control system, flawed combat and dull voice acting, this game deserves to be buried real deep in the earth.

Courtesy SKOAR!

Spiderman 2
Publisher **Activision**
Developer **The Fizz Factor**
Web site www.activision.com/microsite/spider-man
System requirements **600 MHz CPU, 128 MB RAM, DirectX 9.0b compliant 32 MB video card, 827 MB free space**
Price **Rs 1,299**

GAMES

Flirt Up Your Life!

FUYL is definitely for those above 18. It features frontal nudity and some "nasty" scenes as well. The simple "Point 'n Click" interface has a 360-degree camera. Your only objective is to get your character to do the nasty.

FUYL relies on the intricacies of human relationships. Normal Mode places you in an apartment, and you start life with a small amount of money. Earning more money is as easy as [Ctrl] + [P]. Start-From-Scratch gives you an empty flat to insert walls into and add furniture too. You unlock the Villa Mode as you finish the Story Mode, to build your own mansion. Once



you've "scored," the game gets repetitive—you just gotta flirt-eat-earn-flirt-sleep.

The graphic effects are sharp, with perfect character animation. Sound effects are realistic—the groans and grunts of copulation have been carefully recorded.

The game excels from the graphics and sound points of view. However, it loses its replayability due to its monotony. Sex and good special effects alone do not a good game make.

Richard Roy

Singles: Flirt Up Your Life!

Publisher **Eidos** Developer **Rotobee**
Web site www.singles-the-game.com
Price **\$ 29.99 (Rs 1,370)**